

Inflorescence

A group of flowers on a single stem.

Kernel

A grain or the inner part of a fruit, stone, or nut.

Lateral root

A root that extends sideways from a main root to anchor a plant more firmly in the soil.

Leaflet

One of the smaller leaflike parts of a compound leaf growing from the leaf stalk.

Lenticel

One of the tiny pores on a plant stem that helps in the exchange of gases between the plant and its environment.

Lichen

An organism made up of a fungus and an alga, working together.

Monocot

A flowering plant that produces just one seed leaf (cotyledon) when it starts to grow.

Nectar

The sugary liquid produced by plants to attract pollinating animals.

Node

A point on a stem from which leaves, shoots, branches, or flowers can grow.

Nutrients

Minerals used by a plant to fuel its growth.

Parasitic plant

A plant that lives on another and takes nutrients from it.

Petals

The brightly colored parts of a flower that attract pollinating insects and birds to a plant.

Photosynthesis

The process by which a green plant uses the energy in sunlight to create food for itself from water in the soil and carbon dioxide in the air.

Plant

A living organism, from a moss to a tree, that produces its own food by photosynthesis.

Pneumatophore

A straight aerial root that extends upward through swampy soil, enabling a plant to exchange gases, or "breathe."

Pollen

The tiny powdery grains that contain the male reproductive cells, which combine with the female reproductive cells of a plant to make seeds.

Pollination

The transfer of pollen grains from a male flower, or part of a flower, to the female parts of a flower, to fertilize the eggs so seeds can develop.

Pollinator

An animal, such as a bee, moth, or bird, that makes the fertilization of plants possible by moving pollen from flower to flower.

Rhizome

An underground stem that grows horizontally, putting out shoots and roots as it spreads.

Root hair

A microscopic hairlike growth that extends from a root and increases the amount of water and nutrients that a plant can take in.

Sap

The juices in plant cells.

Sepal

A small, leaflike flap, usually green, that surrounds and protects the petals of a flower.

Setting seed

The process in which a plant starts producing seeds after its flowers have been pollinated.

Spore

A tiny reproductive structure found in nonflowering plants such as ferns.

Stamen

The male part of a flower that includes the pollen-producing anther.

Stigma

The female part of a flower.

Succulent

A plant that stores water in thickened, fleshy leaves or stems. Succulents include cacti.

Taproot

A thick, central root that grows straight downward.

Tendrils

A threadlike, twining stalk that vine plants use to attach themselves to a supporting object.

Tepal

A flap around flowers that functions as both a sepal and a petal.

Tuber

A thick underground stem or root that some plants use for storing nutrients.

Vine

A plant that climbs or trails along the ground, supporting its stem with tendrils or by twining itself around a supporting object.

